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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

Business Studies

Marketing

Official Syllabus Unit XI · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Business Studies syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline, Unit XI)	Skills the questions test
Meaning, functions, role, philosophies; marketing vs selling	Marketing – meaning, functions, role and philosophies; Distinction between marketing and selling.	Stating marketing as the satisfaction-of-needs process, ordering the five philosophies, and tabulating marketing against selling on focus, aim, starting point and scope.
Marketing mix and product	Marketing mix – concept and elements; Product – nature, classification, branding, labeling and packaging.	Naming the 4 Ps, classifying goods as convenience, shopping or specialty, and separating brand, label and package.
Price	Price: factors influencing pricing.	Matching a pricing situation to its factor — cost, demand, competition, regulation, objectives, marketing method.
Physical distribution and channels	Physical distribution: meaning, role; Components, Channels of distribution – meaning, types, factors determining choice of channels.	Naming the four components, counting channel levels by the middlemen, and attributing a channel choice to the right factor.
Promotion	Promotion – meaning and role, promotion mix, Advertising, Personal selling, sales promotion and public relation, Role of Advertising, objections to Advertising.	Classifying a described tool into the promotion mix, listing advertising's role, and pairing each objection with its standard reply.

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EXAM PATTERN

CUET UG pattern (NTA official information bulletin and syllabus, 2026 cycle — the current 2027 baseline): each subject paper carries **50 compulsory questions** in **60 minutes**, with +5 for every correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer. Unit XI is the subject's biggest

list chapter — the 4 Ps carry sub-lists everywhere, and classification questions dominate every element.

What Marketing Actually Is

A factory can build a perfect product and still watch it gather dust — because business begins where the **customer's need** begins, not where the production line ends. Marketing is the discipline of beginning there: understanding what people need, shaping an offer around it, carrying it to them, telling them about it, and servicing them after — so that satisfaction and profit arrive together, and keep arriving.

- **Definition:** marketing is a **social process** by which individuals and groups obtain what they need and want through creating, offering and exchanging products of value.
- **Its span:** it starts **before production** (what to make, for whom) and continues **after the sale** (service, feedback, repeat trust) — selling is only one step inside it.
- **Its promise:** profit through **satisfaction** — the customer returns, and brings friends.

The functions of marketing

- **Gathering market information:** studying needs, tastes and rivals before decisions are made.
- **Marketing planning:** translating findings into targets, budgets and programmes.
- **Product designing and development:** shaping the offer the need demands — features, quality, style.
- **Standardisation and grading:** ensuring uniform quality and sorted grades — buyers can trust what they get.
- **Packaging and labelling:** protecting the product and speaking for it on the shelf.
- **Branding:** giving the product a name and identity buyers can remember and repeat.
- **Customer support service:** handling complaints, repairs and queries — the after-sale half of the promise.
- **Pricing:** setting the money value that balances cost, demand and rivalry.
- **Promotion:** telling, persuading and reminding — advertising, selling, incentives.
- **Distribution:** carrying the product to where the customer can reach it.
- **Transportation and warehousing:** moving goods and storing them till needed — time and place utilities created.

The role of marketing

- **To the firm:** marketing earns the revenue that funds everything else — and builds the brand that lets the firm charge fairly.
- **To the consumer:** needs are understood, choices widen, quality improves, information flows — the customer gains power.
- **To society:** employment grows across channels, standards of living rise, and national income expands as production finds its buyers.

The marketing philosophies — five eras of thinking

- **Production concept:** make it cheap and available — buyers want affordable products (early industrial era).
- **Product concept:** make it better — quality and features will sell themselves (the improvement trap: ignoring what buyers actually want).
- **Selling concept:** sell what we make — push through aggressive promotion (goods nobody asked for get forced on markets).
- **Marketing concept:** find what the customer wants and make it — satisfaction first, profit as the reward (the modern base).
- **Societal marketing concept:** satisfy customers **and** society — environment, ethics and welfare join the equation (today's standard).

Marketing vs Selling — The Classic Distinction

Point	Marketing	Selling
Focus	Customer needs — what does the buyer want?	The product — how do we move what we made?
Aim	Profit through customer satisfaction	Profit through sales volume alone
Starting point	Before production — need study first	After production — the goods already exist
Scope	Wide — covers product, price, place, promotion	Narrow — one element inside promotion
Emphasis	Bending the product to the customer	Bending the customer to the product

- **The memory line: selling eyes the product; marketing eyes the customer** — and marketing **includes** selling as one of its many functions.

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The Marketing Mix — Tuning the Four Ps



Figure 1: Figure 1 — The marketing mix: the four Ps with their questions, their sub-elements and the factor lists that tune each one.

- **The concept:** the marketing mix is the set of **four controllable tools** — product, price, place, promotion — that the firm blends to answer the needs of its target market.
- **The blend rule:** the four must **fit together** — a premium product with discount-shelf distribution sends mixed signals and fails both ways.

Product — Nature, Classification, Brand, Label, Package

- **Nature:** a product is **anything of value offered to a market** — goods, services, or a bundle of both with brand and support attached.
- **Consumer goods — classified by buying effort:**
  - **Convenience goods:** bought often, with minimum effort — bread, soap, newspapers; widely spread outlets, low unit price.
  - **Shopping goods:** compared on quality, price and style — clothes, shoes, furniture; fewer outlets, selective stocking.
  - **Specialty goods:** buyers make **special effort** to obtain them — luxury watches, designer wear; one or few exclusive outlets.
- **Industrial goods:** materials and parts, capital items (plant, machinery), and supplies and services — bought for producing other products.

Branding, labelling, packaging

- **Brand:** the **name, term, sign or symbol** that identifies one seller's product and sets it apart — brand name is speakable, brand mark is the drawn part, trademark is the legal protection.
- **Advantages:** easy identification, repeat purchase, differential pricing, a base for new products.
- **Label:** the **written tag** on the product — identity, contents, weight, usage, warnings; labels inform and legally protect.
- **Packaging:** the **wrapper or container** — protection in transit, easy handling, self-promotion on the shelf; modern packaging is called the **silent salesman**.

Price — The Only Revenue-Earning P

- **Meaning:** the money value customers pay for the offer — list price, discounts, credit terms all included.
- **The sensitivity:** price is the fastest lever and the most dangerous — set it above value and buyers flee; below cost and the firm bleeds.

Factors influencing pricing

- **Cost of the product:** total cost — fixed plus variable — sets the floor below which sustained pricing is impossible.
- **Demand and utility:** what buyers can pay and how much they value the product — the utility the product creates sets the ceiling.
- **Competition:** rivals' prices bracket the choice — price above a stronger rival needs a visible reason.
- **Government regulation:** price ceilings and controls on essentials bind the setter's hands.
- **Pricing objectives:** profit max, market share, survival, or premium image — the goal chooses the price path.
- **Marketing method used:** distribution and promotion style affects the price — premium channels carry premium prices.

Physical Distribution and Channels of Distribution

Making the product is half the battle; **placing it within the customer's reach** is the other half — and it is called physical distribution.

- **Meaning:** physical distribution covers all activities that make the product **available at the right place and time** — from factory to doorstep.
- **The four components:**
  - **Transportation:** carries goods between points — road, rail, air, water, pipeline; creates **place utility**.
  - **Warehousing:** stores goods till demand arrives — creates **time utility**.
  - **Inventory control:** decides how much stock to hold — too little breaks sales, too much freezes money.

- **Order processing:** the paperwork-speed of receiving and filling orders — slow orders kill service reputations.

Channels of distribution — the middlemen ladder

- **Meaning:** the channel is the **set of firms and individuals** that take the product from producer to consumer.
- **Zero-level channel (direct):** producer sells straight to the consumer — company outlets, door-to-door, online.
- **One-level channel:** producer → **retailer** → consumer — big retailers buying direct.
- **Two-level channel:** producer → **wholesaler** → **retailer** → consumer — the classic fast-moving consumer goods route.
- **Three-level channel:** producer → **agent** → wholesaler → retailer → consumer — when the producer wants help reaching scattered markets.

Factors determining the choice of channel

- **Product factors:** perishability demands short channels; high unit value and technical complexity favour direct selling.
- **Company factors:** funds available (own sales force vs hired middlemen), desire for control over the channel.
- **Market factors:** number of buyers, geographic spread, order size — scattered small buyers need long channels.
- **Competitive and legal factors:** follow or avoid rivals' channels; some products face legally prescribed routes.

Situation	Suggested channel	Driving factor
Perishable milk and bread	Zero or one level — fast, direct	Product perishability
National FMCG toothpaste brand	Two level — wholesaler to retailer	Scattered mass market
Aircraft engines	Zero level — direct negotiation	High value, technical product, few buyers
New regional clothing brand	One level — established retailers	Company's limited funds, market spread

Promotion — Telling, Persuading, Reminding

A great product at a fair price on every shelf still sells nothing if nobody knows it exists. Promotion is the communication element — informing, persuading and reminding buyers — and it deploys four tools together as the **promotion mix**.

- **Advertising: paid, non-personal** communication through mass media — newspapers, TV, internet, hoardings; one message, millions reached.

- **Personal selling: face-to-face** persuasion by salespeople — flexible to each buyer, builds relationships, answers objections live.
- **Sales promotion: short-run incentives** — discounts, coupons, contests, free samples, festivals offers — designed to trigger a purchase now.
- **Public relations: unpaid image-building** — news stories, events, sponsorships, community work — credibility that advertising cannot buy.

Advertising — role and objections

- **The role:** informs buyers about products and launches; persuades and reminds; widens markets; supports salespeople and dealers; builds brand image; and educates society (health, safety campaigns).
- **The objections:** adds to cost (and thus price); undermines social values by glorifying materialism; confuses buyers with exaggerated claims; and multiplies inferior products' appeal.
- **The standard replies:** large-scale advertising **lowers** per-unit cost by building volume; information empowers consumer choice; and regulation plus self-discipline punish false claims — the tool's misuse is no argument against the tool.

Tool	Best suited for	Signature strength
Advertising	Mass consumer products, launches, reminders	Reach — millions at low per-head cost
Personal selling	Technical, high-value, customised products	Two-way flexibility and trust
Sales promotion	Clearing stock, festivals, trial generation	Immediate action trigger
Public relations	Image repair, launches, community trust	Free and highly credible

Key Facts & Terms Cheatsheet

KEY FACTS & TERMS CHEATSHEET — UNIT XI (MARKETING)

Term / fact	What it means	Example / number
Marketing (meaning)	Social process of satisfying needs profitably — before production, after sale	Selling is one part of it
Functions (10+)	Info, planning, design, standardise, package, brand, support, price, promote, distribute, transport, warehouse	Time and place utilities

Term / fact	What it means	Example / number
Philosophies (5)	Production → product → selling → marketing → societal	Each era widens the focus
Marketing vs selling	Needs vs product; before vs after production; wide vs narrow	Marketing includes selling
Marketing mix	Product + price + place + promotion — the 4 Ps	Price is the only revenue-earning P
Convenience goods	Bought often, minimum effort	Bread, soap, newspapers
Shopping goods	Compared on quality, price, style	Clothes, furniture
Specialty goods	Special effort to obtain	Luxury watch, designer wear
Industrial goods	Materials, parts, capital items, supplies	Bought for producing other products
Brand / label / package	Identity / written description / protective wrapper	Package = silent salesman
Price factors (6)	Cost, demand and utility, competition, regulation, objectives, marketing method	Cost is the floor, utility the ceiling
Physical distribution components (4)	Transportation, warehousing, inventory control, order processing	Place + time utilities
Channel levels	Zero direct; +retailer; +wholesaler+retailer; +agent	Count the middlemen
Channel choice factors	Product, company, market, competition and legal	Perishables go short
Promotion mix (4)	Advertising, personal selling, sales promotion, public relations	PR is free and credible
Advertising objections	Adds cost, undermines values, confuses; reply: volume cuts cost	Tool vs its misuse

Carry everywhere: marketing **includes** selling; effort classifies consumer goods; middlemen count the channel level; only **price** earns revenue.

Common Errors and Special Cases

COMMON ERRORS & SPECIAL CASES

The mistake students make	What is right	The why / the trap
"Marketing and selling mean the same"	Selling is **one function inside** marketing; marketing starts before production	The focus test decides: needs vs product.
"Expensive products are specialty goods"	The class follows **buying effort**, not price alone	A costly item bought casually with little comparison is not specialty — effort is the test.
"Channel level counts every member"	Count only the **middlemen** between producer and consumer	A zero-level channel has no middleman — producer to consumer directly.
"Advertising always raises prices"	Mass advertising builds volume that **lowers** per-unit cost — the standard reply	Cost per contact falls as reach grows; misuse of ads is a separate issue.
"Warehousing and transportation are the same component"	Warehousing creates **time** utility; transportation creates **place** utility	Storing waits for demand; moving reaches it.
"The societal concept and marketing concept are the same"	Societal adds **society's welfare** — environment, ethics — on top of customer satisfaction	The widest lens of the five philosophies.

- **Spot the pattern:** classification rules this unit — goods classes, channel levels, promotion tools, philosophy eras. Learn each class by its **test** (effort, middlemen, payment, era) and the shuffles collapse.
- **One special case:** "the producer sells through the company's own website" is a **zero-level (direct)** channel — the website is the producer itself, not a middleman.

The Whole Chapter on One Page

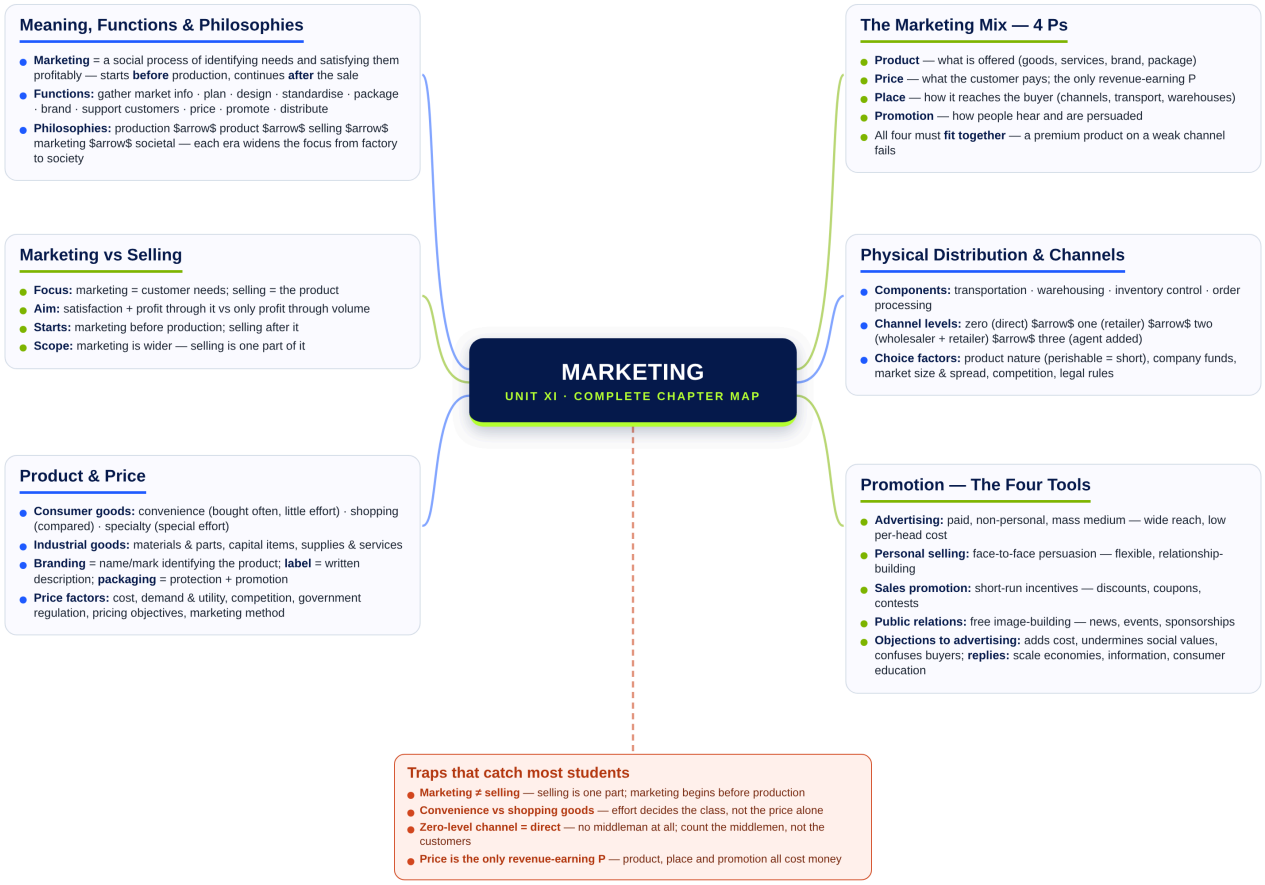


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Whole chapter on one page: meaning, functions and philosophies, marketing vs selling, product classes and branding, price factors, distribution components and channel levels, promotion tools, and the four traps that catch most students.

Practice Questions

Q1. Marketing is best described as:

(A) selling goods at the highest possible price

(B) a social process of identifying needs and satisfying them profitably — beginning before production and continuing after the sale

(C) advertising a product on television

(D) transporting goods to warehouses

Q2. Which philosophy of marketing holds that buyers will favour products of high quality that are improved over time, without studying what buyers actually want?

(A) production concept

(B) product concept

(C) selling concept

(D) marketing concept

Q3. Which statement correctly distinguishes marketing from selling?

(A) selling starts before production; marketing after it
(B) marketing focuses on customer needs while selling focuses on the product
(C) marketing is narrower in scope than selling
(D) selling aims at satisfaction while marketing aims at volume only

Q4. Bread, soap and newspapers that are bought frequently with minimum effort are classified as:

(A) shopping goods
(B) specialty goods
(C) convenience goods
(D) industrial goods

Q5. The written tag on a product giving its contents, weight, usage and warnings is the:

(A) brand
(B) label
(C) package
(D) trademark

Q6. Which factor of pricing sets the **floor** below which the firm cannot price for long?

(A) utility of the product
(B) cost of the product
(C) government regulation
(D) marketing method

Q7. A dairy delivers milk directly to consumers through its own vans and website. The channel level is:

(A) one-level
(B) two-level
(C) zero-level — direct channel
(D) three-level

Q8. The component of physical distribution that creates **time utility** by holding goods until demand arrives is:

(A) transportation
(B) warehousing
(C) order processing
(D) inventory financing

Q9. A company distributes free samples of a new shampoo alongside a festival discount coupon. The promotion tool being used is:

(A) public relations
(B) personal selling
(C) sales promotion
(D) advertising

Q10. "Advertising raises the cost of the product" is an objection whose standard reply is:

(A) advertising never costs anything
(B) large-scale advertising builds sales volume that lowers per-unit cost
(C) all advertised products are of poor quality
(D) only inferior products need advertising

Solutions

Sol. Q1. Marketing is the **social process** of identifying needs and satisfying them profitably — it begins with need study **before** production and continues with service **after** the sale. Advertising and transport are single functions within it.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q2. The **product concept** trusts quality and improvement to sell themselves — the trap being that buyers may want something else entirely. The marketing concept studies the buyer first.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q3. The focus test: marketing centres on **customer needs**, selling on **the product**; marketing begins before production and includes selling as one part of its wider scope.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q4. Frequent purchase with **minimum effort** defines **convenience goods** — wide distribution and low unit prices follow. Shopping goods are compared; specialty goods take special effort.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q5. The **label** is the written information carrier — identity, contents, usage, warnings. The brand identifies; the package protects and promotes.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q6. Cost — fixed plus variable — sets the floor: sustained pricing below total cost bleeds the firm. Utility and demand set the ceiling instead.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q7. No middleman stands between producer and consumer when the firm's **own** vans and website deliver — a **zero-level (direct)** channel. Count middlemen, not touchpoints.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q8. Warehousing holds goods until they are needed — creating **time utility**. Transportation creates place utility; order processing speeds the paperwork.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q9. Free samples and festival coupons are **short-run incentives to buy now** — the signature of **sales promotion**. Advertising informs at mass scale; PR builds image without payment.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q10. The standard reply: mass advertising **builds volume**, and higher volume **lowers per-unit cost** — so the added advertising cost is spread thinner, not simply passed on.

Answer: (B)

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